GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

April 17th, 2026
Week 16
Volume 282, Issue 1231

Highlights:

- **Risk resets.**
- **Demand bites.**
- **Freight runs.**
- **Owners hold.**

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QUOTE of the WEEK

"In the middle of difficulty lies opportunity."

-Albert Einstein

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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CEASEFIRE EXTENDED, NOT RESOLVED

The Week 15 thesis that the war premium was cracking has not held. What looked like a diplomatic off-ramp has narrowed into a less convincing outcome. Washington and Tehran are considering a two-week ceasefire extension, but talks are now focused on a temporary memorandum to avoid renewed conflict, not the broader agreement and Hormuz reopening markets had priced in.

Risk remains elevated. The U.S. has imposed a naval blockade on Iranian ports, while Tehran continues to restrict the Strait of Hormuz to non-Iranian traffic. The Department of Defense is deploying 6,000 additional troops, with a further 4,200 expected by month-end. A ten-day Israel–Lebanon ceasefire offers only limited relief. Markets are not stabilising. They are adjusting to a higher plateau of risk.

Brent traded between USD 94.89 and USD 97.06 per barrel, settling near USD 95, down from Week 15's USD 101 close. The driver has shifted from de-escalation hopes to demand concerns after the IEA cut its 2026 consumption forecast. At the same time, U.S. crude inventories posted a 9.13 million barrel draw against expectations of a 154,000-barrel build, the first draw after seven consecutive weekly increases. The physical market is tight, but sentiment remains uncertain, offering no support for a reopening of supply corridors or a shift in recycling dynamics.

Freight is clearer. The Baltic Dry Index extended its rally to nine consecutive sessions, closing at 2,523 on April 16, up 39 points and at its highest level since early December. Capesize rates moved above 3,100 points to a four-month high on Brazil to China iron ore flows, with Panamax and Supramax also gaining. Improving earnings are keeping older bulkers trading, and the expected Q1 tonnage overhang remains withheld.

Currencies and steel are not the drivers. The USD/INR is around 93.46, Pakistan and Bangladesh remain steady, the Turkish Lira has held its recovery, and the Dollar Index remains near 99. Bangladesh steel holds Week 15 gains, while Pakistan edges higher.

With roughly six weeks before the monsoon window closes, sub-continent fundamentals are supportive. Bangladesh leads on pricing and improving LC flows, Pakistan offers stability, and India retains its HKC advantage. Yet across all three, yards are waiting for ships that owners are choosing not to sell.

The Week 15 expectation of a tonnage release has shifted. Week 16 shows that even a ceasefire extension can keep vessels trading. As Week 17 approaches, the question is whether supply returns before the monsoon or rolls into a backlog, dependent on the Hormuz outcome.

GMS market rankings / pricing for week 16 of 2026 are on Page 5.

BANGLADESH

SIX WEEKS TO MONSOON

Window narrows.

Bangladesh enters Week 16 with its structural pricing advantage intact and its pre-monsoon clock loudest. Local steel plate prices have held at BDT 71,000 per ton, sustaining the USD 578 to USD 584 per ton USD equivalent established the previous week. The USD/BDT rate has remained steady in the 122.70 to 122.85 range, unchanged from the close of Week 14 and Week 15, preserving the direct flow-through of steel strength into offer capacity that continues to distinguish Bangladesh from Alang and Aliaga. Chattogram holds its position as the sub-continent's highest bidder and the most actively engaged recycling market heading into what is now a narrowing operational window. The June rains sit approximately six weeks away. Every week of continued supply hesitation by owners is now a week subtracted from the practical time available to convert appetite into executed transactions before yards are forced to slow beaching cycles.

Compliance lingers.

The Letter of Credit pipeline that defined Q1 friction continues to clear at an accelerating pace. Post-Eid central bank approvals are gathering further momentum entering Week 16, and the structural transaction bottleneck that characterised the opening quarter is now meaningfully less acute. The two OFAC-sanctioned VLCCs at OPL Chattogram enter their fifth week unresolved, and the heightened due diligence culture they have embedded across the cash buyer community remains firmly in place. The compliance shadow over tonnage with opaque documentation continues to slow the introduction of otherwise qualified recycling candidates, and there is no operational development this week that suggests relief. A small number of similarly classified units are reported to remain in cash buyer hands. The LC situation has improved. The compliance situation has not.

Supply decides.

Bangladesh's March 2026 CPI at 8.71% provides continued central bank flexibility on LC approvals without introducing fresh macro concerns. Non-food inflation at 9.09% remains elevated, but the relative macro stability is sufficient to sustain the current transaction environment. The pre-monsoon window is now the dominant operational constraint, and the week-over-week firming of the Baltic Dry Index to 2,523 points has made the supply side harder, not easier. The oil softening of the past ten days has not released the Q1 overhang because owners are no longer treating it as a stabilisation signal. Bangladesh has the financial positioning, the compliance pathway, the urgency, and the pricing. What it does not have, and what it cannot create, is the tonnage. The demand is real. The supply is the problem.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

HORMUZ STILL SHUT, RUPEE DRIFTS

Currency tells.

India's Week 16 is characterised by the continuation of the currency slide that began at the close of Week 15. The USD/INR rate has drifted to approximately 93.46, extending the partial reversal of the RBI-engineered recovery from the Week 14 record low of 94.42. The Strait of Hormuz remains effectively closed with the US naval blockade in place, which directly undermines the directional benefit that the Week 15 oil pullback was supposed to deliver to India's import bill. Approximately 90% of India's LPG continues to transit routes impacted by the Hormuz constraint and approximately 70% of crude is similarly exposed. The intervention capacity of the RBI has not been exhausted, but the appetite to deploy it further in a market where the underlying geopolitical driver has not been resolved is visibly diminished. The currency is telling the truth that the oil market is only hinting at.

Oil misleads.

LPG supply disruptions at Alang's steel mills continue to show only partial easing. Local steel plate prices have oscillated through the week between INR 40,800 and INR 41,900, settling around INR 40,900 at the time of writing, a mid-week pattern that mirrors Week 15's uneven recovery in yard-level energy supply. At a USD equivalent of approximately USD 437 per ton, India remains the lowest-priced destination in the sub-continent, with the gap to Pakistan holding near USD 200 per LDT. This position is not a function of insufficient appetite or insufficient infrastructure. It is a direct consequence of the Hormuz situation's refusal to resolve and the INR's ongoing drift. The oil correction's medium-term benefit to Alang remains conditional on a durable opening of the strait, which the current ceasefire extension does not contemplate, and the US blockade does not permit.

Supply lacking.

India's structural differentiator entering Q2 remains its Hong Kong Convention compliance footprint. More than 110 yards at Alang hold valid Statements of Compliance, a capacity that no other sub-continent destination can match for regulated European and Japanese tonnage at scale. The India CPI for March 2026 was released on April 13, with the RBI reaffirming its 4% inflation target and 2% to 6% tolerance band for the 2026 to 2031 period. The macro foundation for Alang is durable. The supply challenge, the insufficient inflow of recycling candidates to sustain meaningful yard activity, remains the defining constraint and has, if anything, worsened over the past ten days as freight markets have firmed. Alang's readiness is not the question. The question is whether any of the tonnage that owners are currently holding will arrive before the monsoon season closes the beaching window in the Bay of Bengal.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

STABILITY BECOMES ADVANTAGE

Stability holds.

Pakistan's Week 16 extends and arguably intensifies the stability theme that defined Week 15. The Pakistani Rupee has held in a narrow range near 278.90 through the week, essentially unchanged from the close of Week 14 and Week 15, and local steel plate prices at PKR 188,000 per ton have pushed further above the Week 14 level, translating to a USD equivalent near USD 671 per ton. This places Gadani at its firmest absolute USD pricing position of the year. The gap to India has widened modestly to approximately USD 230 per ton at current levels, reaffirming Pakistan's position as the sub-continent's second-most competitive destination with accelerating momentum. March 2026 CPI at 7.3% sits above the State Bank's 5% to 7% target, driven primarily by transport at plus 12.5% on the month and housing, but the trajectory remains manageable for yard economics given the stable PKR base.

Advantage builds.

The continued closure of the Strait of Hormuz and the US naval blockade of Iranian ports are, on balance, reinforcing Gadani's structural positioning rather than eroding it. The speculative risk noted in Week 15, that a broader de-escalation might moderate Pakistan's Gulf proximity advantage, has receded with the narrowing of the US-Iran talks from full settlement to a temporary memorandum. Three HKC-certified yards are now operational with further certifications in the pipeline, and the pool of recycling candidates consisting of medium-sized dry bulk, LPG, and offshore units continues to align well with Gadani's available capacity. The compliance profile is improving. The pricing position is firming. The Gulf logistics advantage is holding. All three reinforcements are operating simultaneously, which is unusual.

Timing risk.

The one remaining unknown for Pakistan is whether the structural position translates into executed transactions before the regional dynamic shifts. A further extension of the ceasefire, or any development suggesting a durable resolution of the Hormuz situation, would begin to erode the proximity premium that has been directing tonnage toward Gadani. For now, this remains a speculative risk rather than an immediate market reality. Pakistan enters the second half of Q2's pre-monsoon window on the firmest footing of its year, with predictable cost inputs, expanding compliance credentials, and a competitive pricing position that is strengthening rather than weakening. The supply variable is shared equally with Bangladesh and India. Whether the oil pullback becomes the catalyst that finally releases the Q1 backlog will be the defining question of the coming weeks, and in that question, Pakistan has perhaps the most to lose if the answer comes quickly, and the most to consolidate if it does not.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

HOLDING, NOT HEALING

Lira pauses.

Turkey enters Week 16 having consolidated rather than extended the modest gains of the previous week. The Turkish lira has held near 44.30 against the US Dollar, essentially unchanged from the Week 15 close of 44.34, with neither fresh downside from the broader geopolitical environment nor meaningful appreciation from the softer Dollar. The Central Bank of Turkey continues to operate with constrained flexibility, having sold more than USD 8 billion in reserves during March and having halted its rate-cutting cycle amid persistent inflation pressures. These dynamics remain unchanged entering Week 16, and the lira's week should be read as a pause rather than a turn.

Inflation diverges.

March 2026 CPI at 30.87% printed below both 31.53% previously and market expectations of 31.4 %, with the softer reading driven by slower price growth in food, housing, and education. Transport costs accelerated to plus 34.35% annually and plus 4.52% on the month as fuel costs filtered through. Independent estimates remain materially higher, with ENAG at 54.62% and Istanbul Chamber data at 37.68%. The central bank's 16% year-end target remains formally in place but is increasingly difficult to reconcile with either the official print trajectory or the independent measurements. None of this shifts the recycling picture.

Niche only.

At USD 268 to USD 290 per LDT across vessel types, Aliaga remains structurally uncompetitive for mainstream tonnage. The gap to Pakistan at approximately USD 445 to USD 480 per LDT, and to Bangladesh at USD 460 to USD 495, is simply too wide to bridge on anything other than EU-regulated tonnage, where Basel Convention compliance overrides price. Turkey's relevance this Q2 is confined to that niche. Outside it, nothing in Week 16 suggests any meaningful shift in positioning, and nothing in the broader geopolitical picture points to one arriving in the near term.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 16 of 2026, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Improving**	460-465 / LDT	480-485 / LDT	490-495 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Firming**	445-450 / LDT	465-470 / LDT	475-480 / LDT
3	India	**Softening**	430 / LDT	450 / LDT	460 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	268-270 / LDT	278-280 / LDT	288-290 / LDT

DID YOU KNOW?

- *The steel recovered from vessels dismantled at Alang to date is enough to manufacture approximately 69 million passenger vehicles.*

- *Under the GMS Sustainable Ship and Offshore Recycling Program (SSORP), over 125 vessels were safely recycled, and more than 100 Inventory of Hazardous Materials (IHM) surveys were conducted across India, Bangladesh, and Turkey*

- *Recycling at Alang cuts CO_2 emissions by over 75% versus conventional steel production routes.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
May 01 – Buddha Purnima	April 16 – April 23 April 29 – May 06

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
May 01 – Labour Day	April 17 – April 20 April 30

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
May 01 – Labour Day	April 23 - National Sovereignty and Children's Day

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ALANG - Port Position as of April 17, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Stolt Cedar	11,436	Chemical Tanker	*Delivered April 16*
2	Stolt Sea	8,074	Chemical Tanker	*Delivered April 16*
3	Agulhas	4,316	Research	*Delivered April 16*
4	FIR 212	730	Yatch	*Delivered April 09*
Morality		*24,556*		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of April 17, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	CAN (D/VSL)	48,125	Barge	Arrived April 16
2	Yu-Ying No.2	1,581	Cadet Training Ship	*Delivered April 11*
2	Isa Golden	6,257	Bulk Carrier	Arrived April 07

GADANI - Port Position as of April 17, 2026

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
No new vessels reported.				
Total Tonnage		-		

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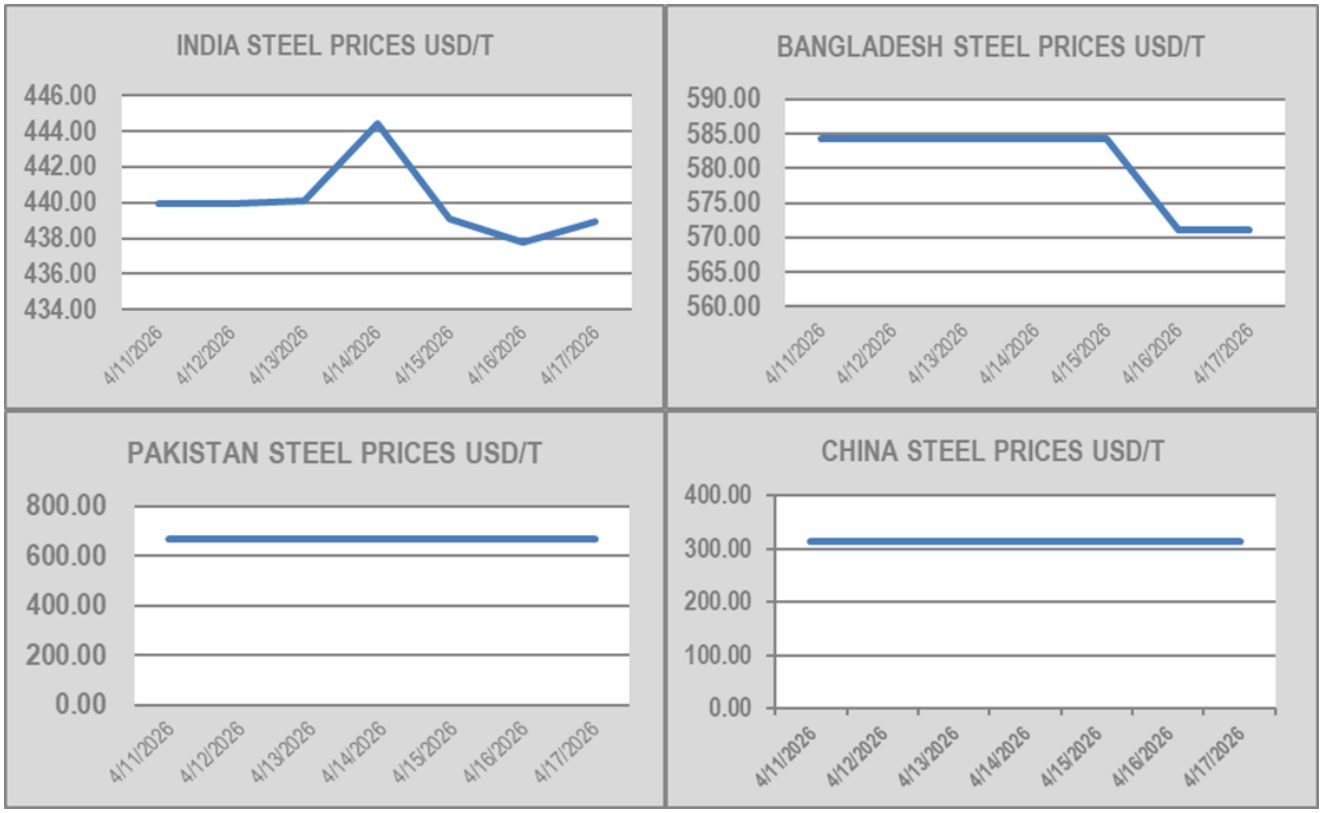
DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
4/11/2026	439.99	40,800.00	671.43	188,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	313.77
4/12/2026	439.99	40,800.00	671.43	188,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	313.77
4/13/2026	440.14	41,100.00	671.43	188,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	313.77
4/14/2026	444.42	41,500.00	671.43	188,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	313.77
4/15/2026	439.07	41,000.00	671.43	188,000.00	584.36	71,000.00	313.77
4/16/2026	437.77	40,800.00	671.43	188,000.00	571.19	69,400.00	313.77
4/17/2026	438.91	40,700.00	671.43	188,000.00	571.19	69,400.00	313.77



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